Levi Q Le

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Staff Software Engineer leading Raft's self-hosted LLM inference platform on EKS GPUs (NVIDIA L4): model serving, an OpenAI-compatible gateway, and chat and coding assistants for IL4 developers. Previously tech lead of a 12-engineer team on Data Fabric, the data platform central to Raft's $450M acquisition by Leonardo DRS. 6+ years building cloud-native infrastructure and data systems for government and financial-services customers — Kubernetes, Kafka, Trino, Go, Java, TypeScript.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

RAFT — Remote (Tampa, FL) *April 2022 – Present*

Staff Software Engineer (2023 – Present)
Associate Software Engineer (2022 – 2023)

- Helped win a multi-million-dollar contract by building a customer-requested feature live during an executive demo.
- Go-to engineer for high-security delivery: lead deployments to air-gapped customer networks — rescuing several ahead of scheduled demos — and troubleshoot production systems on-site in restricted facilities, where debugging happens without internet access or standard tooling.
- Serve as the engineering counterpart to the customer, turning stakeholder requirements into technical designs.
- After a reorg left Data Fabric with ~3 engineers, took on team lead; interviewed and mentored most of the hires that rebuilt it to 12.
- Joined as employee #62 (now 350+); promoted from Associate directly to Staff in one year — skipping the Senior level — with multiple spot bonuses.
- Selected repeatedly for the hackathon teams behind Raft's contract wins, including the one that became CBC2 (below).

AI Inference Platform (Current)

- **Led the org's exploration of AI and built its self-hosted LLM platform from scratch,** stepping in because no one on the team had inference experience; adoption caught on org-wide, and expansion to 50 concurrent users is now proposed with added funding.
- **Built GPU serving on EKS:** Karpenter provisions on-demand NVIDIA L4 nodes (NVIDIA Container Toolkit, device plugin) within GPU-allocation and budget limits, serving models through Ollama.
- **Fronted it with LiteLLM** for auth, rate limiting, and cost tracking, Open WebUI for workspaces and knowledge-base work, and OpenCode coding assistants for IL4 developers, all behind RBAC and SSO.
- **Tuned with Prometheus and Grafana metrics to get the most out of each L4:** model and KV-cache quantization, speculative decoding, and dropping the vision projector.
- **Ahead of the expansion, prototyping the target architecture in a homelab:** vLLM behind KServe, llm-d, and Envoy AI Gateway on Kubernetes.

Vulnerability Assessment Platform (Current)

- Transferred to the contract and built the platform security engineers use to assess release readiness: teams define a release from the Docker images it ships, and the Go/MongoDB backend pulls and aggregates CVE findings for each image automatically, replacing hand-compiled scanner reports.
- Built the TypeScript/React frontend — dashboards, drill-down views, and CVE justification workflows — giving analysts an auditable accept/reject record for each release decision.
- Automated risk scoring and surfaced critical vulnerabilities up front, enabling five analysts to review releases carrying tens of thousands of findings before they ship.
- Built an AI CVE-justification drafter that cuts the ~5-minute-per-CVE research burden with a multi-agent workflow on fully self-hosted models (Ollama, Gemma), so no customer data leaves: one agent drafts justifications from analyst-approved decisions, another curates a knowledge base, and a human analyst approves every draft.

Data Fabric Platform

- Led the platform end to end — data engineering, software, and DevSecOps — onboarding ~10 data vendors and deploying to air-gapped customer networks.
- Anchors the multi-domain data-fusion capability cited in Leonardo DRS's $450M acquisition of Raft (announced July 2026).
- Data Fabric is "Google over your data": users search thousands of datasets across 200+ sources, stream new data in with one click where supported, and see only the rows and columns their access level permits — serving hundreds of users.
- Started building Data Fabric from scratch on joining in April 2022: ingestion via Kubernetes Operators/Controllers and CRDs (Kubebuilder), plus its web app — a Next.js/TypeScript frontend on a Go REST service with Cypress end-to-end tests.

- Integrated Kafka (via Strimzi), JupyterHub, MinIO, Delta Lake, Keycloak, Superset, OPA, Trino, and cert-manager into a single self-service data exploration stack.
- Implemented ABAC row- and column-level data filtering with custom-built Trino and Superset plugins and OPA rules.
- Wrote a dynamic Avro Kafka producer that infers schemas from upstream sources at consume time, letting users run SQL over Kafka data without per-topic configuration or manual schema maintenance — and authored the internal engineering blog post on the technique.

Pipeline & Workflow Automation

- Built pipeline jobs automating manual deployment steps in the org-wide CI/CD flow used by 30+ applications.
- Deployed Backstage with custom plugins that onboarded ~30 teams into the pipelines, giving each a single view of project status, security posture, and compliance readiness.
- Led pipeline observability: integrated GitLab APIs, S3, and Superset to publish metrics on jobs, security, and operations.

Communication Broker Channel Platform (CBC2)

- Designed Raft's initial architecture and built the technical foundation for CBC2 — a real-time data pipeline supporting mission-critical decision-making in the field — at contract kickoff, while continuing to lead Data Fabric.
- Designed and implemented the pipeline's ingest, validation, and enrichment stages with Kafka Streams in Scala, serving live data to consumers over WebSockets.
- Met the contract's throughput requirement of 10,000 messages per second by optimizing every stage of the pipeline and redesigning the components that became bottlenecks.

JPMORGAN CHASE — Tampa, FL *June 2018 – March 2022*
Software Engineer (2020 – 2022)
Software Engineering Intern (2018, 2019)

- **Software Engineer Program (SEP):** Graduated the bank's two-year program in 18 months and mentored four junior engineers.
- **Service Container Platform:** Built four utilities (Messaging Toolkit, Messaging Failure Handler, Message Retry, Service Validation Suite) for a shared payments library adopted by ~30 teams org-wide; helped containerize ~10 legacy Java apps onto the bank's internal Kubernetes platform.
- **Billing & Pricing Platform:** Developed and maintained backend REST services for client charge processing, load-tested with JMeter and BlazeMeter. Single-handedly built Kafka and IBM MQ messaging utilities to read and publish messages.
- **Integrated Receivables (2019 internship):** Built a full-stack web application that onboards new clients to the program and version-tracks each configuration file.
- **Image-to-Text Ground Truth Collector (2018 internship):** Built a web app collecting human-labeled OCR training data.

SKILLS & TECHNOLOGIES

AI Inference: LLM serving on Kubernetes (EKS, Karpenter, NVIDIA L4), Ollama, vLLM, KServe, llm-d, Envoy AI Gateway, LiteLLM, Open WebUI, OpenCode; model and KV-cache quantization, speculative decoding; multi-agent workflows, tool calling
Languages: Go, Java, Python, Scala, JavaScript/TypeScript, SQL, Bash
Platform & Cloud: Docker, Kubernetes (Operators, CRDs, Kubebuilder), Helm, Istio, AWS (EKS, S3), Azure (AKS), MinIO, Linux
Architecture: Distributed systems, microservices, event-driven streaming, ETL
Data & Streaming: Kafka (Streams, Connect, Strimzi), IBM MQ, Avro, Trino, Delta Lake, Superset, PostgreSQL, MongoDB
Backend & Frontend: Spring Boot, Quarkus, REST APIs, WebSockets, React, Next.js, Material UI
Security & Identity: Keycloak, OPA/Rego, OAuth, SSO, ABAC, DevSecOps
Testing & CI/CD: JUnit, Mockito, Hamcrest, Cypress, JMeter, GitLab CI/CD, Backstage, Git
Spoken Languages: English (bilingual proficiency), Vietnamese (native)

CERTIFICATIONS & CLEARANCES

- Certified Kubernetes Application Developer (CKAD), 2025
- CompTIA Security+ (SY0-701)
- Active U.S. Government TS/SCI Clearance (2022 – Present)

EDUCATION

B.S., IT Software Development — Florida International University (2019) — *magna cum laude*; second focus in cybersecurity

SIDE PROJECTS

Tea Shop Operations Automation Platform

- Built a full-stack ops system for a local tea shop, in production at up to 100 orders/day: Square POS linked to standardized recipes, a self-service kiosk, and a live prep queue; cut new-hire ramp-up from a month to a few days.